

11... Nf4 is another possibility as if White takes on f4 Black takes on d4. This was quite popular until White started playing the simple 12 Rfd1!. After both 12... Nxe2+ 13 Ncxe2 and 12... Nxd4 13 Bxd4 Qg5 14 Bf1 Bxd4+ 15 Qxd4 White's extra space gives him a small but lasting advantage and such positions are difficult to defend

12 Nxc6 bxc6 13 c5?!

Until recently this move was awarded an '!' as nobody had spotted the tactical resource that allows Black to force a draw. A better line is 13 exf5 Bxf5 when White should avoid 14 g4? because 14... Bxc3! followed by 15... Qe7 ensures that Black doesn't lose a piece. Instead, after 14 Bd4 Nf6 15 Rfe1 c5 16 Bf2 Qd7 17 Rad1 Qf7 18 b3 White, again, has a small plus because of his better pawn structure and safer king

13...d5!

Black suffered with other moves but they are now all redundant

14 exd5

14 Bg5 is the only way to continue the game but it looks OK for Black after 14...Qd7!

14...Bxc3! (Diagram 16)

This is the big new idea



NOTE: Sometimes even obvious tactical continuations are missed by strong players when the first move would normally be considered as a positional mistake. It is harder for King's Indian players to see tactics that involve giving up the King's Indian bishop.

15 bxc3

15 Qxc3? f4! costs White a piece. The original game in this line, Krivoshey-Gutman, Rovno 2000 continued 16 Bc4 Rxe3 17 d6+ Be6 18 Bxe6+ Rxe6 19 Qb3 Qd7 20 Rae1 Rae8 21 Rxe6 Rxe6 22 Re1 Ng7 23 dxc7 Kf7 24 Re4 Qxc7 and Black soon won.

15...Qe7 16 Kf2 Qh4+ 17 Kg1 Qe7 18 Kf2 Qh4+ Draw agreed

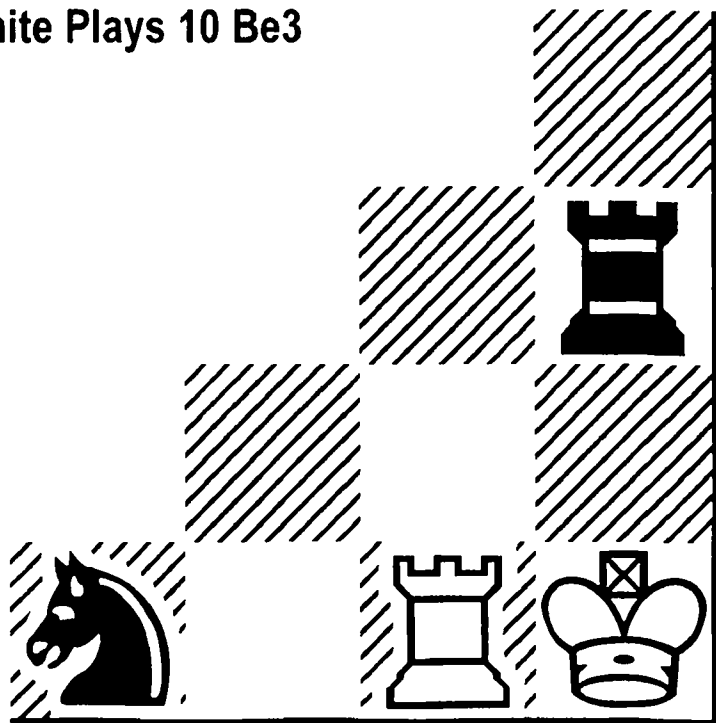
Summary

- 1) This chapter contains several important lines of the Classical. They are ideal for those who wish to avoid the theoretical battles of the next two chapters. They may also be of interest to players who do not wish to put all their eggs in one basket and prefer flexible play.
- 2) 7...Na6 has become important. It was virtually unknown at the start of the 1990's but rapidly developed into a major system. It is not easy for White to prove an advantage with either of the main lines.
- 3) 7...Nbd7 is no longer popular. Nowadays it is mainly of historical interest with very few strong players willing to employ it regularly.
- 4) 7...exd4 looks reasonable. It is probably a little better for White but there are quite a few pitfalls for him to avoid

Chapter Three

The Classical with 7 0-0 Nc6: The Main Line 9 Ne1

- Introduction
- Main Lines with 10 Nd3
- White Blocks the Kingside with g2-g4
- White Plays 10 Be3



Introduction

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Be2 0-0 6 Nf3 e5 7 0-0 Nc6

In the previous chapter we saw various seventh move alternatives for Black. Now we are moving into the main line, the heart and soul of the King's Indian. By playing 7...Nc6 Black leaves White little choice but to close the centre. He is even willing to have his knight driven to the inferior e7-square in order to achieve this central clarification. The reason Black wants the centre closed is that he wants to attack on the kingside and this is not possible with a fluid centre.

8 d5

The only serious alternative is 8 Be3. This would be played more often if it wasn't for the reply 8...Re8!. This leads to a completely equality after 9 d5 Nd4! 10 Nxd4 exd4 11 Bxd4 Nxe4 12 Nxe4 Rxe4 13 Bxg7 Kxg7 and a dull, level game after 9 dxe5 dxe5 and a subsequent exchange of queens. Black can also go fishing in murky waters with 8...Ng4!? when 9 Bg5 f6 10 Bc1 transposes directly to Game 6.

8...Ne7 (Diagram 1)

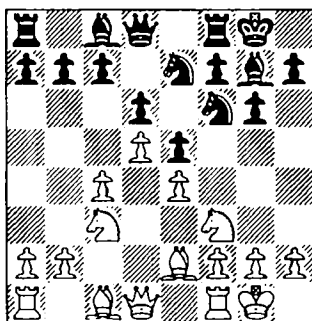


Diagram 1
The centre is blocked

We have now reached the starting point for the most heavily analysed variation in the King's Indian. The material is spread over two chapters. Here we shall look at the old main line with 9 Ne1 whilst the next chapter deals with the important alternatives 9 b4 and 9 Nd2.

9 Ne1

Why does White retreat a well developed piece?

Well, now that the centre has been duly closed the players will have to look for active play on the wings. White's pawns on d5 and c4 give him a space advantage on the queenside so it is logical that he attacks

on that side of the board. Black will attack on the kingside. However, there is not much chance of an attack until he seizes some space on this side of the board. This will be achieved by moving his knight from f6 and advancing the f-pawn. In order to preserve his central structure White would like to meet ...f7-f5 with f2-f3. Therefore he has to move his knight from f3. He doesn't have to move it at once but if he does so it prevents Black's most active move with the king's knight, ...Nh5. That is the thinking behind 9 Ne1 (and 9 Nd2). There is an alternative plan for White. He can leave his knight on f3 and meet ...f7-f5 with Ng5 and a subsequent Ne6. For example, 9 b4 Nh5 10 Re1 f5 11 Ng5 is the main line of the Bayonet Attack.

9 Ne1 or 9 Nd2?

So once White has decided to move his knight, the next question is where? Well, that is a matter of taste. After 9 Ne1 White often follows up with Nd3 which will make it easy for him to organise c4-c5. However, once c4-c5 has been played it is not easy to find an offensive role for the knight on d3 so it usually retreats to f2 to help in the defence of his king. On other occasions White leaves the knight on e1 and tries to force through c4-c5 with the help of Be3.

9 Nd2 envisages a more aggressive role for the knight. Once White has played c5 this knight will move into c4 after which it will be perfectly placed to take part in the demolition of Black's queenside. The drawbacks to this approach are that it might not be so easy to achieve c5 without the help of this knight and that the kingside will have less protection against Black's attack. As I said both approaches are equally valid and 9 Nd2 is considered in the next chapter.

9...Nd7

Just like White before him, Black has a choice of knight retreats (he is going to play ...f7-f5). The alternative, 9...Ne8, is less common for a couple of reasons. Firstly, on e8 the knight does not control the e5-square so White can contemplate variations based on f4. Secondly, the knight on e8 does nothing to slow down c4-c5. For example, after 10 Be3 f5 11 f3 f4 12 Bf2 White can play c4-c5 next move without further preparation.

After 9...Nd7 White usually chooses between 10 Nd3 and 10 Be3. They each have their own section. He can also play 10 f3 followed by g2-g4 and this is found in the section on blocking up the kingside.

Main Lines with 10 Nd3

1 d4 Nf6 2 c4 g6 3 Nc3 Bg7 4 e4 d6 5 Be2 0-0 6 Nf3 e5 7 0-0 Nc6 8 d5 Ne7 9 Ne1 Nd7 10 Nd3 f5 11 Bd2

White normally waits for Black to play ...Nf6 before playing f2-f3. This gives Black the chance to make the positional mistake 11...f4 which is strongly met by 12 Bg4!.



NOTE: An exchange of light-squared bishops is usually in White's favour. Because of the central pawn structure Black's bishop is more active and normally plays an important role on the kingside.

11...Nf6 12 f3 f4

So the stage is set. Black closes the centre in anticipation of an attack against the white king. This is the real starting point of the variation and in a tournament game this position would often be reached after just a couple of minutes play.

13 c5

13 g4 is considered in the next sub-section

13...g5 14 cxd6

Sometimes White plays 14 Rc1 first but it just transposes after 14...Ng6 15 cxd6 cxd6.

14...cxd6 (Diagram 2)

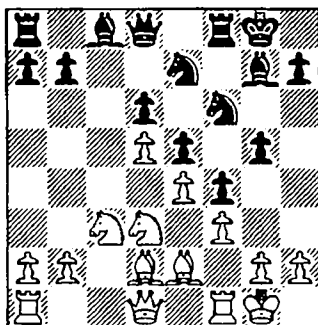


Diagram 2
The battle begins

Now White has two lines. 15 Rc1 is the subject of Game 12 and 15 Nf2 is covered in Game 13.

Theoretical?

At master level we are in the most theoretical territory of the King's Indian. However, as both sides have relatively straightforward plans to follow it should be easy enough to get by without learning everything off by heart.

Statistics

With 9 Ne1 as a whole White has scored 58% from over 5000 games. From the diagram position above White has also scored 58%. Above average, but not dramatically so.